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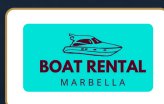
VESSEL SPECIFICATION

Red Tide

A dedicated sport-fishing boat built for Marbella's offshore grounds, departing Puerto Banus with a skipper and mate who know where the fish hold.

BOATHIRE24 FLEET EDITORIAL

FROM THE FLEET OF



Principal Particulars

VESSEL	Red Tide	TYPE	Sport-fishing boat
LENGTH	11 metres	GUEST CAPACITY	Up to 6 anglers
BUILDER / CLASS	Custom sport-fisher	DEPARTURE PORT	Puerto Banus, Marbella
CREW	Skipper plus mate included	FISHING FIT-OUT	Outriggers, fighting chair, livewell, rod holders
RANGE	Deep-sea offshore	RATE BAND	Quote on WhatsApp via the website

SECTION 01

Overview: a purpose-built fishing boat in a fleet of leisure yachts

Most of the boats that leave Puerto Banus on a summer morning are built to be admired. Red Tide is built to work. She is an 11 metre sport-fishing boat, kitted out for one thing above all others, which is to put up to six anglers onto fish in the deep water off Marbella and bring them home again with something to show for it. In a fleet that otherwise leans towards flybridge motor yachts and superyacht charters, she is the specialist, and that is exactly why she stands out.

What makes a dedicated sport-fisher different from a motor yacht with a couple of rods thrown in the locker is the fit-out. Red Tide carries **outriggers** to spread a trolling pattern, a **fighting chair** to take the strain out of a long battle with a big fish, a **livewell** to keep bait fresh and lively, and the rod holders, gaffs and tackle that turn a day on the water into a proper day's fishing. None of that is decorative. Every piece of it earns its place because the boat is set up to chase pelagic species in open water rather than to anchor in a bay and serve cava.

The other half of the package is the people. Red Tide comes with a **skipper and a mate**, and on a fishing boat the crew matter more than on almost any other charter. A flat blue sea looks identical everywhere to the untrained eye, but the productive ground is not everywhere, and a crew who fish these waters week in and week out know where the bait is balling up, where the temperature breaks sit and how the season is running. You are not just hiring a boat. You are hiring local knowledge with a hull under it.

She departs from Puerto Banus, which puts the best of the western Costa del Sol's offshore water within an easy run, and she takes a maximum of six guests, which keeps the cockpit workable rather than crowded when the rods go off. Pricing on Red Tide is quoted on request through WhatsApp on the website, because a fishing charter is shaped around the trip you actually want, the hours you want on the water and the time of year you are coming. The rest of this dossier walks through who builds boats like this, how she is laid out, what a day aboard looks like, where she fishes and how to book her.



♦ *Red Tide, an 11 metre sport-fishing boat working out of Puerto Banus, Marbella.*

SECTION 02

The custom sport-fisher tradition

Red Tide is listed as a custom build rather than a production model from a single named shipyard, and that is worth dwelling on, because in the sport-fishing world a custom boat is not a compromise. It is often the ideal. Serious offshore fishing boats have a long heritage of being built or heavily modified to a purpose, and the discipline grew up around yards and builders who started with the question of how to catch fish and worked backwards from there to the hull.

The lineage most people picture when they think of a sport-fisher runs through the great American convertible yards, the Carolina custom builders of the United States east coast, and the European and Mediterranean workshops that adapted those ideas to local waters. The shared idea across all of them is a boat with a sharp, deep entry forward to cut a head sea, plenty of flare to throw spray clear, a broad and stable stern to give a steady working platform when the boat is stopped and a fish is at the side, and a cockpit kept deliberately low and open so that the angling space is the heart of the boat rather than an afterthought.

A custom or semi-custom sport-fisher of Red Tide's size sits in the practical sweet spot for day charter. She is big enough to be safe and comfortable in offshore water and small enough to be nimble, economical to run and quick to set up for a session. A custom boat in this class is typically the product of an owner and builder who cared about the details that a production buyer might never notice, the placement of the rod holders, the height of the covering boards for resting a rod butt, the drainage in the cockpit so a wet deck clears fast, the sight lines from the helm to the spread of lines behind the boat. Those are the things that separate a boat that catches fish from a boat that merely goes fishing.

Because Red Tide is a custom vessel rather than a catalogue model, the right way to think about her marque is the philosophy rather than a brand badge. She belongs to the tradition of boats built by people who fish, for people who fish, and that intent shows up in every part of her layout.

What the sport-fishing class is known for

If you have only ever been on a leisure cruise, it is worth understanding what a sport-fishing boat is designed to do, because it explains why Red Tide looks and behaves the way she does. The class exists to troll, drift and bottom-fish in open water, and almost every design decision serves one of those three jobs.

Trolling is the technique of towing baits or lures behind a moving boat to cover ground and find feeding fish. The **outriggers** are the long poles that swing out to the sides, and their job is to hold lines wide of the boat's wake so you can run several baits at once without them tangling, spreading a pattern that looks to a predator like a small school of fleeing baitfish. This is the signature look of a sport-fisher under way and it is what Red Tide is rigged to do.

The **fighting chair** is the second giveaway. When a large, powerful fish takes a bait, the fight can last a long time, and trying to hold a heavy rod by hand against that pull is exhausting and inefficient. The fighting chair is bolted to the cockpit sole and lets an angler brace, plant the rod butt in a gimbal and use the legs and back rather than just the arms, turning a war of attrition into something controlled. It is the difference between landing a serious fish and losing it to fatigue.

The **livewell** serves the bait. Many of the most effective methods in this water rely on live bait, and live bait only works if it is genuinely lively. The livewell is an aerated tank that keeps baitfish swimming and healthy until they go on the hook, which is a far more productive approach than fishing with bait that died hours ago. Add the array of **rod holders** around the cockpit and on the hardtop, plus the gaffs, nets and tackle that a working boat carries, and you have a vessel that is ready to switch between methods as the day and the fish dictate. That adaptability, the ability to troll on the way out, drift over a mark and switch to live bait if the trolling goes quiet, is exactly what the sport-fishing class is celebrated for.

On board: cockpit, helm and working layout

Step aboard Red Tide and the priorities are immediately obvious. The cockpit is the largest single space on the boat and it is kept deliberately clear, because this is where the fishing happens. Around its edges sit the rod holders, the covering boards are at a height made for resting against while you watch the spread, and the **fighting chair** commands the centre so that whoever is hooked up has room to work the fish through three hundred and sixty degrees as the skipper backs down or turns to keep the line clear of the hull.

The **outriggers** stand folded against the hardtop or superstructure when the boat is at the dock and swing out once she is on the troll, transforming a tidy profile into the wide-armed silhouette of a boat that means business. The **livewell** sits within easy reach of the cockpit so the mate can re-bait quickly, and the tackle, gaffs and landing gear are stowed where they can be grabbed in the urgent seconds when a fish comes to the boat.

Forward of the cockpit is the helm, set up so the skipper can see the spread of lines astern as well as the water ahead, which matters enormously when a strike can come at any moment. The electronics that a

fishing boat lives by, the sounder that reads the bottom and marks bait and fish, the chart plotter that holds the productive marks, and the radio, are the instruments that earn their keep here rather than the cocktail fridge that headlines a leisure yacht.

Red Tide carries up to **six anglers**, and that number is chosen for fishing rather than for sunbathing. Six gives you a sociable group with enough hands to keep several lines working without the cockpit becoming a scrum when things get busy. There is shaded space to get out of the midday sun and the practical comforts you need for a long day on the water, but make no mistake, the layout is honest about what this boat is for. The water toys here are fishing tackle, and the highlight reel is written in outriggers, a fighting chair, a livewell and a crew who know how to use all three.



♦ Outriggers, fighting chair and a clear working cockpit define Red Tide's deck.

SECTION 05

A day aboard: an offshore charter from Puerto Banus

Here is how a day on Red Tide tends to unfold. You meet the boat at Puerto Banus, ideally early, because the first light of morning is often the most productive window of the whole day and because the sea is usually at its calmest before the breeze builds. The skipper and mate greet you, run through the safety brief and the plan, and once everyone is settled the lines are let go and the marina slips away behind you.

The run out is part of the experience. As Marbella's coastline opens up astern, the mate begins to set up, swinging out the outriggers and rigging the spread, and the skipper steers for water he has reason to believe is holding fish, a depth contour, a temperature edge, a patch of bait marked on the sounder. There is a particular calm to this part of the morning, the boat settling into a trolling speed, the baits skipping in the wake, everyone watching the lines with that low hum of anticipation that anyone who fishes will recognise.

Then a reel screams. A line pops from the outrigger clip, the rod loads up, and the cockpit comes alive. The mate clears the other lines, you get into the fighting chair, the skipper works the boat to keep you

connected, and for the next stretch of time nothing else exists but the fish on the end of the line. Whether it comes to the boat or throws the hook, that moment is the reason people charter a sport-fisher rather than a pleasure boat, and on a good day it happens more than once.

Between the action there is the easy rhythm of a day on the water, the sun climbing, the coast a low blue line, a drink and a bite to eat, conversation, and the steady attention to the spread that fishing rewards. If the trolling goes quiet the crew may switch tactics, dropping live bait from the well over a mark or drifting a likely patch of ground. As the booked hours wind down the boat turns for home, the outriggers come in, and Red Tide runs back to Puerto Banus with the satisfaction of a day spent doing the thing the boat was built for. You step back onto the pontoon tired in the good way, salt on your skin and stories to tell.

SECTION 06

Cruising and fishing grounds from Marbella

Puerto Banus is an excellent base for offshore fishing because it sits roughly in the middle of a coastline that drops away into deep, productive water and because it is within reach of the convergence of the Mediterranean and the Atlantic at the Strait of Gibraltar, one of the great pinch points for migrating fish anywhere in Europe.

The home water off Marbella and the Golden Mile gives quick access to the offshore grounds without a punishing run, which is part of what makes a day charter worthwhile here, you are fishing rather than commuting. To the east the coast runs past Cabopino with its marina and dune-backed beaches, and the water beyond holds plenty of interest for boats working the contours. To the west the coastline carries on past Estepona, and beyond that the land begins to turn towards the Strait.

The headline ground is the deep water off the western Costa del Sol and, on longer trips, the approaches to the Strait of Gibraltar, where the geography funnels bait and predators through a relatively narrow corridor and where the seasonal procession of pelagic species passes close to shore. The species and the timing change through the year, and that is precisely where the value of a local skipper shows, since the right ground in June is not the right ground in October. Whatever the season is offering, the crew shape the day around where the fish actually are rather than around a fixed itinerary.

Because the productive water is genuinely offshore, conditions matter, and the skipper will always have an eye on the wind and sea state when planning how far to run. On a settled day the range opens up and the longer runs come into play. On a breezier day there is still good fishing closer to home. The flexibility of a crewed charter means the plan adapts to the morning you actually get rather than the one you hoped for, which on the water is always the right way round.

SECTION 07

Who Red Tide suits

Red Tide is a specialist boat and she suits people who want to fish, which sounds obvious but is the single most important thing to be clear about before booking. If your group's idea of a perfect day is anchoring in

a quiet cove, swimming off the back and working through a few bottles of cava, this is not the boat, and the fleet has handsome motor yachts that do exactly that. If, on the other hand, you want the thrill of a screaming reel and a real chance at a serious fish, she is purpose-built for the job.

She works beautifully for a **group of up to six anglers**, which is a natural size for friends who fish together, for a father and his grown-up children, or for a small party of colleagues looking for a day out with more to it than a boat trip. Six is enough for the social side and the shared excitement, and few enough that everyone gets time in the fighting chair and hands on the rods rather than standing around watching.

She is a strong choice for a **special occasion** with a difference, a milestone birthday, a stag celebration that wants substance rather than just sunbathing, a reunion of old fishing friends, or simply a bucket-list day for someone who has always wanted to fish the deep water off southern Spain. Visiting anglers who fish at home and want to experience Mediterranean and Atlantic-influenced water find her ideal, and so do complete beginners, because the skipper and mate handle the technical side and coach you through your first fish.

What ties all of these together is intent. Red Tide rewards people who come to fish and who value the expertise of a crew over the trappings of a luxury cruise. Bring that mindset and she delivers a day that a leisure yacht simply cannot.

SECTION 08

Pricing and what is included

Red Tide is priced on request rather than from a fixed published rate card, and there is a good reason for that. A fishing charter is shaped around the trip you actually want, the number of hours you spend on the water, and the time of year you are coming, since the run to the productive ground and the methods that work change through the season. The fairest way to price that is to quote the specific day, which is why the rate is given on WhatsApp through the website.

To get a quote you simply send a message via boatrentalinmarbella.com with your preferred date, the number of anglers in your group and roughly how long you would like to be on the water, and the team comes back with a price and availability. It is a quick conversation and it means the number you get is for the trip you are actually planning rather than a generic figure you then have to qualify.

What is included follows the standard the whole Marbella fleet charters to, so you know what you are getting before you ask. Every charter comes with the following.

INCLUDED AS STANDARD		DETAIL
Licensed skipper	Professional captain at the helm	
Mate	Deckhand to rig, bait and work the cockpit	
Fuel	Included in the charter	
Drinks	Water, soft drinks, beer, white wine and cava	
Light snacks	Provided on board	
Insurance	Vessel and charter cover	
Safety equipment	Lifejackets and required gear	
VAT	21 per cent included in the quote	

The two inclusions that matter most on a fishing day are the ones a leisure charter does not need. The **skipper and mate** are both part of the deal, which means you have a captain finding and working the fish and a deckhand keeping the cockpit running, rigging tackle, re-baiting and gaffing, so you can concentrate on the fishing rather than the chores. **Fuel is included**, which on an offshore boat that may run some distance to reach the grounds is a genuine convenience, and with **VAT already in the quoted figure** there are no surprises at the end. Drinks and light snacks keep the group going through a long day on the water.

SECTION 09

Seasonality and weather windows

The Costa del Sol gives one of the longest and most reliable boating seasons in Europe, and that generosity extends to fishing. The core summer months from June through September bring long days, warm water and the settled mornings that make for comfortable offshore trips, and they are the busiest time for charter, so popular dates are worth booking well ahead.

The shoulder seasons of spring and autumn are quietly excellent and often underrated. The weather is frequently still very pleasant, the marinas are calmer, and the fishing can be outstanding as the seasonal movement of pelagic species brings different fish within reach. What is biting and where it is holding shifts through the calendar, which is once again why the crew's local knowledge is the most valuable thing on the boat, they read the season and aim the day at whatever is running.

Wind and sea state are the real variables for an offshore boat rather than the calendar date. Because the productive water is genuinely out from the coast, the skipper plans the day around the forecast, choosing how far to run and which ground to work based on the conditions on the morning. A breezy day does not necessarily mean no fishing, it may simply mean fishing closer to home or adjusting the plan. The early

start that fishing rewards also tends to catch the calmest part of the day, before any afternoon breeze fills in, which is another reason the boat likes to leave early.

The honest position is that fishing is fishing, and no crew can guarantee a particular catch on a particular day, but a skipper who works this water through the whole season stacks the odds as far in your favour as anyone can. Come with realistic expectations and an early alarm, and the season will mostly reward you.

SECTION 10

Booking practicalities and frequently asked questions

Booking Red Tide is straightforward. You enquire through boatrentalinmarbella.com, request a quote on WhatsApp with your date, group size and preferred hours, and the team confirms price and availability. Below are the questions that come up most often.

How many people can come fishing? Up to six anglers. That number keeps the cockpit workable and gives everyone real time on the rods rather than standing around watching.

Do I need any fishing experience? None at all. The skipper and mate handle the technical side, set the spread, rig the tackle and coach you through your first fish, so complete beginners are very welcome. Experienced anglers equally enjoy fishing alongside a crew who know the local ground.

Where does the boat leave from? Puerto Banus in Marbella, which gives quick access to the offshore grounds and, on longer trips, the water towards the Strait of Gibraltar.

How much does it cost? Red Tide is quoted on request. Send your date, group size and the hours you want on the water via WhatsApp on the website and you will get a price for your specific trip. Pricing this way keeps the figure honest to the day you are actually booking.

What is included in the price? A licensed skipper and a mate, fuel, drinks of water, soft drinks, beer, white wine and cava, light snacks, insurance, safety equipment and VAT at 21 per cent. The skipper and mate together are the two inclusions that make the difference on a fishing day.

What should I bring? A hat, sunglasses, sunscreen and a light layer for the run out are sensible, along with anything you would want for a long day on the water. The crew supply the fishing gear and the boat's tackle, so you mainly need to bring yourself and an appetite for it.

Can you guarantee we will catch fish? No honest crew can promise a particular catch on a particular day, because fishing depends on conditions and on the fish. What you do get is a skipper and mate who fish this water all season and who put you on the most productive ground the day allows, which is the best any charter can offer.

What is the best time of year to come? Summer is the peak for settled weather and long days, while spring and autumn are quieter and often produce excellent fishing as the seasons turn. The crew aim the day at whatever is running when you come.

Book Red Tide from Puerto Banus

Red Tide is the Marbella fleet's dedicated sport-fishing boat, 11 metres, up to six anglers, outriggers, a fighting chair and a livewell, with a skipper and mate who know where the fish hold. Charters depart Puerto Banus and are quoted on request, so you get a price for the exact trip you want.

- ✦ **Book this boat** and request a quote on WhatsApp at boatrentalinmarbella.com
- ✦ **Boat owners** can list a boat for free worldwide at boathire24.com

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